FUNCTIONAL CONSUMPTION PLAN

Ascensus

A delivery-ready services-entitlement work plan that translates confirmed VCF outcomes into design artifacts, high-level SOW work packages, technical gates, implementation sequencing, and delivery handoff.

Dresher, Pennsylvania | Not Yet Confirmed | 2026-09-29 to 2027-09-29 | Service delivery & adoption | Technical handoff

Prepared for customer and delivery planning

EXECUTIVE SNAPSHOT

Functional Consumption Plan

A delivery-focused view of confirmed outcomes, the Entitlement Adoption Timeline, and the separate Two-Year Notional.

ENTITLEMENT VALUE	OBSERVED FOOTPRINT	REPORTED ESXI	DELIVERY POSTURE
—	**3,348 VM records**	**2 releases**	**Design to adoption**
2026-09-29 to 2027-09-29	135 ESXi hosts	VMware ESXi 8.0.3 build-24859861 · 114 hosts; VMware ESXi 8.0.3 build-25595708 · 21 hosts	Estate evidence supports validation

CUSTOMER BACKGROUND

Ascensus

Ascensus is preparing a delivery-led VCF adoption that converts confirmed outcomes into an implementation sequence, operating-model transition, and service handover. The plan is framed around operations and lifecycle management, automation and self-service foundations, the explicitly selected VCF networking and NSX scope and private AI enablement, with an in-place modernization path. Delivery planning is informed by a current-state estate view used as supporting evidence and validation context, rather than as a completion measure.

LOCATION

Dresher, Pennsylvania

DELIVERY FOCUS

Design artifacts, implementation sequencing, adoption outcomes, lifecycle enablement, and service handover

PLANNING BASIS

Entitlement Adoption Timeline with a separate 24-month notional view

PLAN SYNOPSIS

Customer-aligned delivery plan

The plan is framed around operations and lifecycle management, automation and self-service foundations, the explicitly selected VCF networking and NSX scope and private AI enablement, with an in-place modernization path.

Two-Year Notional: this directional 24-month view begins at the planned project start (2026-09-30) and extends continued adoption beyond the immediate entitlement drawdown where appropriate.

Entitlement Adoption Timeline: this is the two-year delivery horizon beginning 2026-09-30. It uses calendar-month execution windows and connects each work package to lead resource guidance, dependencies, gates, and concurrent workstreams.

Plan on a Page

The plan translates selected service outcomes into delivery work, using estate evidence only to inform planning conditions and validation.

Customer and Delivery Summary

01 Customer delivery context

Ascensus is preparing a VCF adoption focused on delivering the confirmed platform outcomes through a sequenced implementation, operating-model transition, and service handover. Estate evidence informs delivery conditions and validation; it does not define the customer story or completion measure.

02 Observed footprint

3,348 virtual machines across 135 ESXi hosts, 26 clusters, and 3 datacenters. Reported ESXi: VMware ESXi 8.0.3 build-24859861 (114 hosts); VMware ESXi 8.0.3 build-25595708 (21 hosts).

03 Selected scope

The plan is framed around operations and lifecycle management, automation and self-service foundations, the explicitly selected VCF networking and NSX scope and private AI enablement, with an in-place modernization path.

04 Entitlement details

Not Yet Confirmed is available through 2027-09-29. The Entitlement Adoption Timeline shows the planned drawdown sequence; the separate Two-Year Notional extends the directional adoption roadmap to 24 months.

05 Entitlement Adoption Timeline

The entitlement drawdown schedule begins and uses . Lead delivery roles, scoped work packages, and concurrent workstreams are derived from the authoritative plan.

Timeline Validation

Timeline validation: The current plan is within the configured timeline bounds. Confirm sequencing and prerequisites with the customer before delivery.

VCF 9.1 Readiness

A concise readiness summary for delivery decisions, validation priorities, and mobilisation sequencing.

PRESALES-TO-DELIVERY HANDOFF

ESXi 9.1 compatibility posture

Catalog-versioned server and CPU evidence, current-estate context, release disposition, and owned delivery actions.

TARGET RELEASE LISTED	BLOCKED / NOT LISTED	EVIDENCE REQUIRED	ESTATE RECONCILIATION
135 hosts	**—** hosts	**—** hosts	**Complete** 135 of 135 imported hosts are reconciled to a compatibility cohort.

Maintained evidence baseline

broadcom-server-2026-07-28

3,423 server records across 74 manufacturers; release scope ESXi 9.0 and ESXi 9.1; captured 2026-07-28T17:47:28Z.

Observed ESXi: VMware ESXi 8.0.3 build-24859861 · 114 hosts; VMware ESXi 8.0.3 build-25595708 · 21 hosts

Priority delivery actions

1. **88 hosts · Delivery engineering**
   Retain the HCL evidence in the delivery baseline and validate NIC, HBA/controller, firmware, driver, OEM image, storage, vSAN/ReadyNode, build, and topology requirements before deployment. Do not select ESXi or VCF 9.2 for this B200 M5 cohort. Keep the cohort on ESXi 9.1 or plan a supported hardware refresh before a 9.2 adoption; recheck the current Cisco and Broadcom compatibility matrices if either vendor publishes a revised listing.
2. **43 hosts · Delivery engineering**
   Retain the HCL evidence in the delivery baseline and validate NIC, HBA/controller, firmware, driver, OEM image, storage, vSAN/ReadyNode, build, and topology requirements before deployment.
3. **4 hosts · Delivery engineering**
   Retain the HCL evidence in the delivery baseline and validate NIC, HBA/controller, firmware, driver, OEM image, storage, vSAN/ReadyNode, build, and topology requirements before deployment. Do not select ESXi or VCF 9.2 for this C220 M5 cohort. Keep the cohort on ESXi 9.1 or plan a supported hardware refresh before a 9.2 adoption; recheck the current Cisco and Broadcom compatibility matrices if either vendor publishes a revised listing.

Server-and-CPU support is one gate. Delivery must also validate NICs, HBAs/controllers, firmware, drivers, OEM image or add-on, boot, storage, vSAN/ReadyNode where applicable, and cluster topology. The standalone compatibility deliverable contains the complete cohort evidence and action register.

Two-Year Notional

24-month adoption view: This monthly view begins at the planned project start, preserves any intentional gap before implementation, and extends through a full two-year planning horizon. It is a directional adoption roadmap, not a commitment that all work is funded by the current entitlement.

PLANNED PROJECT START THROUGH MONTH 24

Two-Year Adoption Outlook

The notional runs from 2026-09-30 through Aug 2028 and shows continued adoption, lifecycle, governance, and handover beyond the immediate Entitlement Adoption Timeline where appropriate.

DELIVERY WORKSTREAM KEY

- Governance
- Operating Model / Platform
- Infrastructure Build
- Migration Waves
- Consume / Handover
- Security & Resiliency

Delivery Category	Sep 30, 2026	Oct 2026	Nov 2026	Dec 2026	Jan 2027	Feb 2027	Mar 2027	Apr 2027	May 2027
Program Management & Governance	Month 1: Mobilize and Establish Delivery Baseline				◆ HCL Gate: Red — procurement or greenfield provisioning				
Modernize Infrastructure		Procure Replacement Hardware or Approve Greenfield Path		Provision and Validate Greenfield Hardware Baseline					Prepare Suppo
Operations	Confirm Upgrade Requirements and Constraints	Design VCF 9.1 Target State and Record Decisions	Design Management Domain, Platform, and Prerequisites	Design Upgrade Runbook, Validation, and Change Windows	Design VCF Operations Adoption — depth to be confirmed	Design VCF Automation and Self-Service — depth to be confirmed	Design VCF Networking and NSX — depth to be confirmed	Design Private AI Platform and Governance — depth to be confirmed	
Modernize Cloud									
Modernize Security & Resilience									

Entitlement Adoption Timeline

Delivery resource view: This schedule turns the approved adoption plan into scoped delivery work packages. Resource roles and calendar windows are planning guidance; delivery leadership validates effort, availability, named resources, and commercials before mobilization.

VCF 9.1 Pathway and Design Deliverables

In-place upgrade: Upgrade the supported existing vSphere estate in place, validate it, and bring the accepted platform under VCF management.

Decision inputs: Exact vCenter and ESXi builds · HCL-supported host cohorts · Upgrade sequence · Rollback method · Change windows

Required Design Package

Design Work Package	Issued Outcome	Dependencies	Acceptance Direction
1. Confirm Upgrade Requirements and Constraints Design	Issue the requirements and constraints register, including support boundaries, rollback limits, freeze periods, and customer acceptance conditions.	RVTools estate evidence, exact product builds, HCL disposition, and customer change calendar.	Infrastructure, application, and change owners confirm the baseline and constraints.
2. Design VCF 9.1 Target State and Record Decisions Design	Issue the decision register and logical target state for domains, clusters, component placement, storage, networking, and management ownership.	Confirmed requirements and supported upgrade pathway.	Architecture owners approve the target state and decision rationale.
3. Design Management Domain, Platform, and Prerequisites Design	Issue the logical and physical platform design, host and cluster placement, IP/VLAN, DNS/NTP, and prerequisite closure plan.	Target-state decisions and accepted HCL evidence.	Platform, network, storage, and operations owners accept the detailed design.
4. Design Upgrade Runbook, Validation, and Change Windows Design	Issue the implementation runbook with prechecks, sequencing, rollback, post-upgrade health checks, and acceptance criteria.	Approved platform design, backup and recovery controls, and customer change calendar.	Change authority approves the runbook, rollback plan, validation evidence, and execution windows.

Implementation and Adoption Package

Work Package	Delivery Outcome	Entry Gate	Acceptance Direction
1. Execute Approved In-Place Upgrade and Validation Waves Implementation	Upgrade the approved vCenter and ESXi cohorts to the target release and retain post-wave health evidence.	Approved runbook, closed HCL prerequisites, recoverable backups, and approved change windows.	Each wave passes platform health, management, storage, network, and workload validation.
2. Bring the Upgraded Platform Under VCF Management Adoption	Establish the accepted VCF management and lifecycle operating model for the upgraded estate.	Accepted upgrade waves and supported VCF management pathway.	Lifecycle, monitoring, backup, ownership, and escalation controls are operational.

LEAD DELIVERY ROLES	WORK PACKAGES	PEAK CONCURRENT PACKAGES
5	20	2

Lead Delivery Role	Workstream	Delivery Window	Packages	Planned Work
Engagement Manager / Project Manager	Governance	Sep 26 – Jan 27	2	Month 1: Mobilize and Establish Delivery Baseline · HCL Gate: Red — procurement or greenfield provisioning
VCF Architect + Operations Lead	Operating Model / Platform	Sep 26 – Nov 27	12	Confirm Upgrade Requirements and Constraints · Design VCF 9.1 Target State and Record Decisions · Design Management Domain, Platform, and Prerequisites · Design Upgrade Runbook, Validation, and Change Windows · Design VCF Operations Adoption — depth to be confirmed · Design VCF Automation and Self-Service — depth to be confirmed · Design VCF Networking and NSX — depth to be confirmed · Design Private AI Platform and Governance — depth to be confirmed · Bring the Upgraded Platform Under VCF Management · Publish Operational Dashboards and Service Measures · Deploy VCF Operations Health, Logs, and Diagnostics · Validate Handover, Service Acceptance, and Ongoing Lifecycle
VCF Implementation Engineer	Infrastructure Build	Oct 26 – Jun 27	3	Procure Replacement Hardware or Approve Greenfield Path · Provision and Validate Greenfield Hardware Baseline · Prepare Supported Estate for In-Place Upgrade
Migration Lead + Application Owners	Migration Waves	Jul 27 – Jul 27	1	Execute Approved In-Place Upgrade and Validation Waves
Automation / Platform Engineer	Consume / Handover	Aug 27 – Sep 27	2	Enable Automation and Self-Service · Onboard the First Private AI Pilot

Resource guidance supports delivery planning. Delivery leadership must confirm named resources, effort, utilization, regional availability, customer responsibilities, commercial rates, and formal acceptance criteria before work begins.

OPERATIONAL DELIVERY HORIZON · YEAR 1

Sep 26 through Aug 27

This executive monthly view preserves the full delivery horizon without reproducing detailed weekly execution mechanics. Activities spanning a boundary continue in the next view.

DELIVERY WORKSTREAM KEY — Governance · Operating Model / Platform · Infrastructure Build · Migration Waves · Consume / Handover · Security & Resiliency

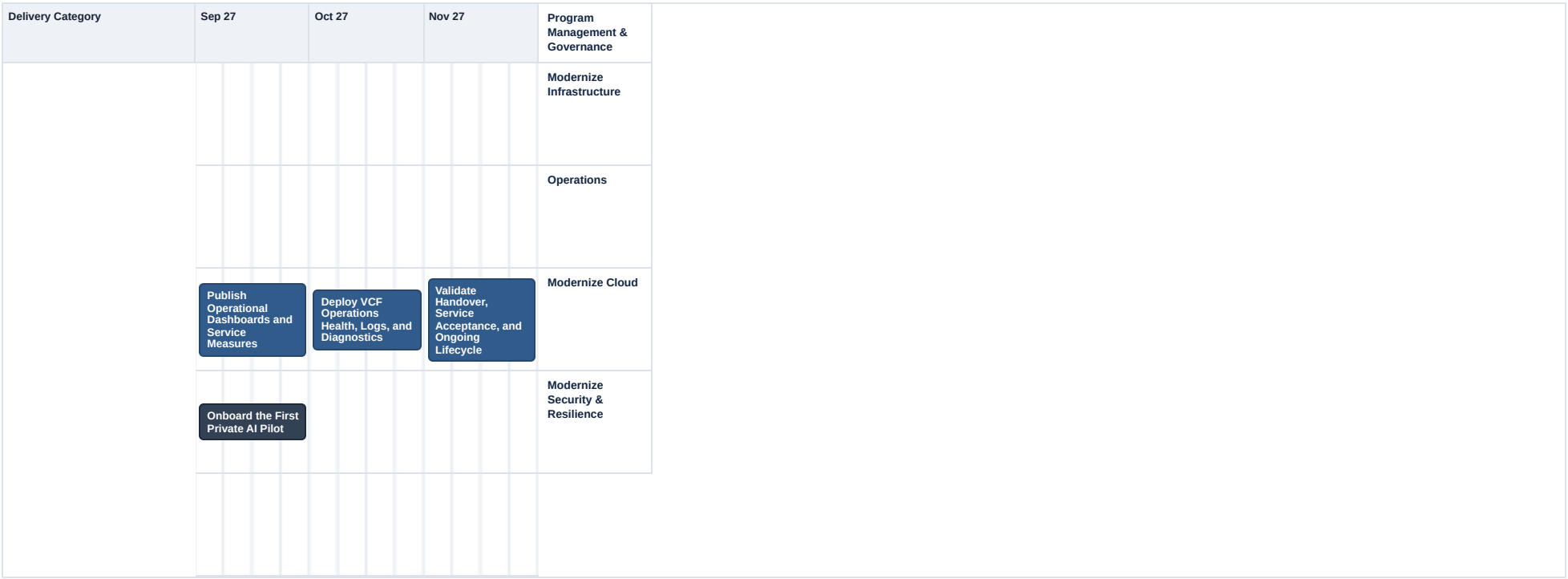
Delivery Category	Sep 26	Oct 26	Nov 26	Dec 26	Jan 27	Feb 27	Mar 27	Apr 27	May 27	Jun 27	Jul 27	Aug 27
Program Management & Governance	Month 1: Mobilize and Establish Delivery Baseline				◆ HCL Gate: Red — procurement or greenfield provisioning							
Modernize Infrastructure		Procure Replacement Hardware or Approve Greenfield Path		Provision and Validate Greenfield Hardware Baseline					Prepare Supported Estate for In-Place Upgrade		Execute Approved In-Place Upgrade and Validation Waves	
Operations	Confirm Upgrade Requirements and Constraints	Design VCF 9.1 Target State and Record Decisions	Design Management Domain, Platform, and Prerequisites	Design Upgrade Runbook, Validation, and Change Windows	Design VCF Operations Adoption — depth to be confirmed	Design VCF Automation and Self-Service — depth to be confirmed	Design VCF Networking and NSX — depth to be confirmed	Design Private AI Platform and Governance — depth to be confirmed				Bring the Upgraded Platform Under VCF Management
Modernize Cloud												Enable Automation and Self-Service
Modernize Security & Resilience												

OPERATIONAL DELIVERY HORIZON · YEAR 2

Sep 27 through Nov 27

This executive monthly view preserves the full delivery horizon without reproducing detailed weekly execution mechanics. Activities spanning a boundary continue in the next view.

DELIVERY WORKSTREAM KEY: Governance | Operating Model / Platform | Infrastructure Build | Migration Waves | Consume / Handover | Security & Resiliency



High-Level SOW Work Package Register

The register carries the same authoritative timeline into delivery scope, role ownership, outcomes, dependencies, and assumptions.

Work Package	Lead Delivery Role	Start Month	End Month	Outcome / Acceptance Direction	Dependencies and Assumptions
PROGRAM MANAGEMENT & GOVERNANCE					
Month 1: Mobilize and Establish Delivery Baseline Governance	Engagement Manager / Project Manager	Sep 26	Sep 26	Use the opening window to capture the offline HCL evidence, design decisions, and remaining delivery dependencies; implementation services begin only in the selected implementation window.	RVTools identifies 135 observed hosts across 4 host models. HCL schedule path Red: Red — procurement or greenfield provisioning. The supplied offline HCL snapshot lists the reported model and resolved CPU series for 135 host(s); retain that evidence while completing the full configuration review. Confirm server configuration, CPU, NIC, storage controller, firmware, driver, vSAN/ReadyNode details, bill of materials, and implementation prerequisites before platform deployment begins.
HCL Gate: Red — procurement or greenfield provisioning Governance	Engagement Manager / Project Manager	Jan 27	Jan 27	Authorize foundation work only after the required HCL path evidence is recorded.	2.0.0 Red gate closes after procurement or greenfield provisioning is accepted.
MODERNIZE INFRASTRUCTURE					
Procure Replacement Hardware or Approve Greenfield Path Infrastructure Build	VCF Implementation Engineer	Oct 26	Nov 26	Secure the supported hardware path before downstream domain build activities begin.	Proceed only after the Red HCL result has a replacement, repurpose, or approved exception decision.
Provision and Validate Greenfield Hardware Baseline Infrastructure Build	VCF Implementation Engineer	Dec 26	Dec 26	Validate the newly provisioned hardware baseline before releasing VCF deployment work.	Start after procurement, hardware delivery, and rack-and-stack acceptance.
Prepare Supported Estate for In-Place Upgrade Infrastructure Build	VCF Implementation Engineer	May 27	Jun 27	Release only the supported host and management cohorts into the approved upgrade waves.	Begin after the HCL gate and approved upgrade runbook; close platform, backup, firmware, driver, lifecycle, and management prerequisites.

Work Package	Lead Delivery Role	Start Month	End Month	Outcome / Acceptance Direction	Dependencies and Assumptions
Execute Approved In-Place Upgrade and Validation Waves Migration Waves	Migration Lead + Application Owners	Jul 27	Jul 27	Upgrade the approved vCenter and ESXi cohorts to the target release and retain post-wave health evidence. Acceptance: Each wave passes platform health, management, storage, network, and workload validation.	Approved runbook, closed HCL prerequisites, recoverable backups, and approved change windows.
OPERATIONS					
Confirm Upgrade Requirements and Constraints Operating Model / Platform	VCF Architect + Operations Lead	Sep 26	Sep 26	Issue the requirements and constraints register, including support boundaries, rollback limits, freeze periods, and customer acceptance conditions. Acceptance: Infrastructure, application, and change owners confirm the baseline and constraints.	RVTools estate evidence, exact product builds, HCL disposition, and customer change calendar.
Design VCF 9.1 Target State and Record Decisions Operating Model / Platform	VCF Architect + Operations Lead	Oct 26	Oct 26	Issue the decision register and logical target state for domains, clusters, component placement, storage, networking, and management ownership. Acceptance: Architecture owners approve the target state and decision rationale.	Confirmed requirements and supported upgrade pathway.
Design Management Domain, Platform, and Prerequisites Operating Model / Platform	VCF Architect + Operations Lead	Nov 26	Nov 26	Issue the logical and physical platform design, host and cluster placement, IP/VLAN, DNS/NTP, and prerequisite closure plan. Acceptance: Platform, network, storage, and operations owners accept the detailed design.	Target-state decisions and accepted HCL evidence.
Design Upgrade Runbook, Validation, and Change Windows Operating Model / Platform	VCF Architect + Operations Lead	Dec 26	Dec 26	Issue the implementation runbook with prechecks, sequencing, rollback, post-upgrade health checks, and acceptance criteria. Acceptance: Change authority approves the runbook, rollback plan, validation evidence, and execution windows.	Approved platform design, backup and recovery controls, and customer change calendar.
Design VCF Operations Adoption — depth to be confirmed Operating Model / Platform	VCF Architect + Operations Lead	Jan 27	Jan 27	Issue the Operations architecture, data sources, dashboard and alert scope, lifecycle ownership, and operating acceptance criteria. The committed adoption depth is depth to be confirmed.	Confirm the operations depth, platform owners, telemetry sources, and support model.
Design VCF Automation and Self-Service — depth to be confirmed Operating Model / Platform	VCF Architect + Operations Lead	Feb 27	Feb 27	Issue the organization, project, catalog, blueprint, policy, approval, source-control, and service-ownership design. The committed adoption depth is depth to be confirmed.	Confirm the automation depth, catalog product owner, tenant model, approvals, and integration boundaries.
Design VCF Networking and NSX — depth to be confirmed Operating Model / Platform	VCF Architect + Operations Lead	Mar 27	Mar 27	Issue the physical fabric, transport zone, Edge, routing, overlay, IP, MTU, and network-operations design. The committed adoption depth is depth to be confirmed.	Confirm network ownership, fabric standards, routing handoffs, NSX scope, and selected adoption depth.
Design Private AI Platform and Governance — depth to be confirmed Operating Model / Platform	VCF Architect + Operations Lead	Apr 27	Apr 27	Issue the GPU capacity, workload-domain, data boundary, model access, security, lifecycle, pilot, and acceptance design. The committed adoption depth is depth to be confirmed.	Confirm funded GPU capacity, a named use case, data classification, security approval, and selected adoption depth.
Bring the Upgraded Platform Under VCF Management Operating Model / Platform	VCF Architect + Operations Lead	Aug 27	Aug 27	Establish the accepted VCF management and lifecycle operating model for the upgraded estate. Acceptance: Lifecycle, monitoring, backup, ownership, and escalation controls are operational.	Accepted upgrade waves and supported VCF management pathway.
Publish Operational Dashboards and Service Measures Operating Model / Platform	VCF Architect + Operations Lead	Sep 27	Sep 27	Implement the selected operating capability with accountable ownership and measurable service outcomes.	Begin after workload-domain readiness and the HCL gate.
Deploy VCF Operations Health, Logs, and Diagnostics Operating Model / Platform	VCF Architect + Operations Lead	Oct 27	Oct 27	Implement the selected operating capability with accountable ownership and measurable service outcomes.	Begin after workload-domain readiness and the HCL gate.
Validate Handover, Service Acceptance, and Ongoing Lifecycle Operating Model / Platform	VCF Architect + Operations Lead	Nov 27	Nov 27	Confirm operational readiness, evidence, ownership, and the continuing lifecycle cadence.	Begin after the final migration or implementation wave is accepted.
MODERNIZE CLOUD					
Enable Automation and Self-Service Consume / Handover	Automation / Platform Engineer	Aug 27	Aug 27	Enable the confirmed cloud capability on the accepted VCF foundation.	Begin after pathway execution and platform acceptance.
Onboard the First Private AI Pilot Consume / Handover	Automation / Platform Engineer	Sep 27	Sep 27	Enable the confirmed cloud capability on the accepted VCF foundation.	Begin after pathway execution and confirmed GPU, data-governance, and security controls.
MODERNIZE SECURITY & RESILIENCE					